

Philipp Hilbert. *Founding product operator, zero to one and beyond.*

Positioning, hands-on PM with ten years of B2B SaaS and enterprise software delivery who builds the systems that let product teams move faster without losing rigor.

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Dear Farseer team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role because the problem you are solving is one I find genuinely interesting: rebuilding the operational layer of enterprise software from first principles, starting with finance. That is a harder problem than it looks, and the job description suggests you already know why – it is not a technology gap, it is a workflow and trust gap. Finance teams have been burned by software that promised clarity and delivered complexity. Closing that gap requires a PM who can sit in the room with CFOs, understand what they are actually doing (not what the persona doc says they do), and translate that into something engineering can ship without losing the nuance.

That is the work I have done across most of my career, in different domains but with the same mechanics. At Emil Group, I inherited a B2B InsurTech platform where client trust had broken down, sprint discipline had collapsed, and a 17-person team was producing noise instead of output. I split the team, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, ran weekly product workshops with clients directly, and reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure. The product shipped. At Rohde and Schwarz, I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end on a government defence programme where requirements were incomplete by design and the cost of a wrong decision was measured in months, not sprints. I unblocked infrastructure problems independently that engineers had been deferring for over a year. At the Federal Employment Agency, I served as both PM and Deputy IT Security Officer on a public analytics platform, managing compliance, data lineage, and a migration to Kubernetes while continuing to ship features.

On the finance domain gap: I have not been a full-time PM inside an FP&A software company. I have operated as CFO and financial planning lead at Smart Soil Technologies, which gave me direct exposure to how finance workflows actually run under pressure – budget cycles, forecasting under uncertainty, investor reporting, and the gap between what a spreadsheet

shows and what a decision-maker needs. I understand the problem from the user side. The PM skill I bring – structured discovery, workflow decomposition, requirements that engineers can act on – transfers directly once the domain vocabulary is mapped.

What I am specifically drawn to in the Farseer role is the framing around doing product management rather than presenting it. I have spent my career in environments where the processes did not exist yet and someone had to build them while also shipping. I do not need consensus to make a call, and I am comfortable defending a no on a feature when the evidence points that way. I am also technically fluent enough to challenge architectural assumptions in the room with engineers, not just relay them – at Rohde and Schwarz I was the sole contributor on a feature the project lead had been requesting from the engineering team for over a year. I delivered it in one week.

I would welcome a conversation about where Farseer is in its product development cycle and what the most important unsolved prioritization problem looks like right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
